The Imperative of Knowing God

Every human life, born of a woman, is defined by one factor: who they believe God is. The imperative to know God is known in every life, "because that which is known about God is resident within them." Romans 1:19 If that individual gives no thought to who God is, beyond believing that they themselves are their own god, their life will reflect that. Humanists are an example of such people, who elevate the potential of man to the exclusion of God. Everything you need is within you.

Some believe in God, yet they give Him little thought or attention. They have little understanding of who God is, so despite acknowledging God's existence, their lives reflect that limited understanding. They feel no compulsion to seek God more; they just want to live a comfortable life. Yet when the chips are down and calamity strikes, they may turn to God and ask for help. Depending on how the episode unfolds, they may react differently. If it goes their way, they thank Him and go on. However, if it does not go their way and they suffer the consequences of their choices, they may downgrade their belief after praying. Their lives will reflect their choices about who they believe God is.

Because God is merciful, and His love is beyond our comprehension, He reveals Himself to people. Those who have ears to hear, having encountered the truth about God, hear Him and believe. They are transformed within by the power of the Holy Spirit, who dwells within them. As a result, they seek to know God even more. Their lives continually change to reflect God's life. As Scripture says, out of his innermost being, torrents of living water will bubble up within him.

A second reason it is imperative to know God is this: Knowing God determines the quality of one's life. The more one seeks to know God and is transformed by that progressive understanding, the more they grow in His love for others, enter His peace in all circumstances, and experience unchanging joy!

When we stop to consider what every human being craves, it is love—to love and be loved; to experience a joy in life that never leaves; and a peace that transcends any circumstance. Every person on earth would consider these qualities more valuable than anything else. Many have spent millions to acquire them, only to fail. Many seek them in other things or in relationships, only to come up empty.

You find it in knowing God through the Lord Jesus Christ, who died for us and reconciled us to our Father. Once reconciled, the glorious journey begins.

How would you answer that question? Who do you believe God is? How well do you know Him?